Ishkhan Khchoian

Product Manager — discovery, requirements & delivery

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Armenian (native, C2) · English (C1) · Russian (C2)

PROFILE

What I bring to product is six years of the work underneath it: talking to users, finding the real problem behind the stated one, and writing it down clearly enough that engineers can build from it. For six years that was my job in everything but name — client intake was my daily work, and the people I interviewed described symptoms rather than problems and withheld the detail that decided the outcome.

Since leaving law in February 2026 I have made it formal: a U.S.-standards project management course, 2nd place at HackNation, a month of C at 42 Yerevan, and my own B2B concept around AI voice/text agents and RAG — which has taught me more about where products fail than any course would.

One interview is enough — give me 30 minutes and a real problem from your team, and you'll see how I work.

WHY ME FOR THIS ROLE

- **Discovery.** Several hundred structured intake interviews. The skill a product discovery call needs — asking past the stated request — is the one I have been practising longest.
- **Requirements that survive contact with engineering.** I rewrote the workflows, templates and checklists at M&M and they became the team standard. Writing something precise enough that other people execute it without me is the part I enjoy most.
- **Metrics and evidence.** Six years of legal analysis: read a dense corpus, find the one fact that decides the outcome, and defend the reasoning in writing. That transfers directly to reading a funnel and defending a prioritisation call.
- **Shipping alongside engineers.** A month of C at 42 Yerevan and an AI product concept of my own — enough to follow a technical trade-off discussion rather than nod through it.
- **Delivery discipline.** 12 complex projects in parallel, 8 specialists coordinated, events for up to 3,000 people. A crowded roadmap will not overload me.
- **Founder-adjacent by habit.** I am used to being handed the ambiguous half of a problem — I deputised for the team lead at Shamayev and was the escalation point at M&M.

SKILLS

- **Product.** user interviews and discovery · writing requirements, user stories and acceptance criteria · backlog grooming · roadmap input · experiment design · metric definition and tracking · competitor and market research
- **Delivery.** scope and timelines · Agile/Scrum · risk tracking · SOPs and checklists · cross-functional coordination · stakeholder communication
- **Tools.** Jira · Confluence · Notion · Trello · Monday · Google Analytics · AmoCRM · Bitrix24 · Google Workspace · basic C

EXPERIENCE

Freelance — legal & project work · PM training Feb 2026 – present

- Legal: IP assignment for works of popular musicians; corporate structure for a crypto trader; advised on opening a crypto-exchange office in Armenia.
- Projects: COO of the **SayWhen.am** startup (AI voice agents); business research for a water production line; CPA/affiliate manager (under NDA); sale of family real estate; designed a US client-acquisition pilot for **Karas Systems** (B2B go-to-market consultancy).

Senior Case Manager — M&M Document Preparation Jun 2025 – Feb 2026

- Ran up to **12 complex client projects in parallel** end to end — requirements, planning, execution and delivery against immovable external deadlines.
- Coordinated **8 specialists**, reviewed their output against defined acceptance criteria and acted as the escalation point.
- Rewrote the team's workflows, templates and checklists; they became the default way of working.

Event / Project Manager — Hosq Corp. Jan 2025 – Jun 2025

- Delivered live events for audiences of **100 to 3,000** — several in parallel, on dates that could not slip.
- Owned vendors, logistics, scheduling and day-of operations.

Project Manager — Qanon Construction Aug 2024 – Dec 2024

- Client communication, scope agreement, timelines and internal follow-through across daily operations.

Senior Paralegal — Shamayev Business Law Corp. · Paralegal — Bloomrich Law Firm Feb 2023 – Aug 2024

- Built and taught the **Paralegal Academy**, an internal training programme; the materials went on to serve **50+ people**.
- Carried key accounts with full autonomy and deputised for the team lead.

Judge's Associate — Arbitration Court of the Magadan Region Nov 2021 – Dec 2022

- **200+ parallel cases, 30+ hearings a week**, covering three roles at once — sustained parallel workload without dropping state.
- Drafted judicial acts, managed case materials and kept document flow moving.

Assistant Lawyer — Bar Association Dec 2019 – Aug 2021

- Civil-contract analysis and claims; legal support to a trade and construction organisation.

Administrator / Project Manager — LLC "SIS" (construction & retail group) Jun 2015 – Sep 2019

- **15+ construction and retail projects**, at times three sites at once, with teams of 2–20; contractors, procurement, transport, tenders and recruitment.
- Built the first schedules and Gantt charts used across the projects.

EDUCATION & TRAINING

- **Project management, U.S. standards** — "Project Management with a U.S. Perspective: Skills for Global Success" — Yerevan American Corner, a joint program of the U.S. Embassy Yerevan and the City Central Isahakyan Library; 21 Jul – 21 Aug 2026, in person, Certificate of Achievement.
- **Project Management** — PM Club, 2023 (52 academic hours).
- **Piscine intensive (C programming)** — 42 Yerevan, Nov–Dec 2025; passed selection, alongside a full-time job.
- **Bachelor of Law, with honours** — North-Eastern State University, 2021.
- **Civil Law, Faculty of Law** — St. Petersburg State University, 2016.

ALSO

- **2nd place, HackNation** local pitches, final at TUMO Labs (July 2026); **Startup Seaside Summit** — participant.
- **Highload++** (700 attendees) — organising team, led a crew of 12; performance bonus.
- **Ethos Foundation** — HQ coordinator, Sep 2023 – Oct 2024; aid to ~100 families a day.